Upgrade Programme (CSUP). The interns work in various divisions and gain experience, increasing their employability.

Tata Chemicals Magadi supplies 64 per cent of the water of the Magadi division. They also provide water via railway wagons, using their railway network to reach communities far away from the plant. The plant has also been encouraging women to do business and work in the various stores situated in and around the plant, Sayanka adds.

A training facility for training for dealers and mechanics was also set up by Tata Motors in Africa. Taking forward Ratan's philosophy, the group has assisted the Ugandan government to improve its tax collection system.

Ratan's continued emphasis on a localized approach has also won community support for the Tata companies. He worked to reduce the appearance of Tata Magadi as a foreign company by providing succour to the indigenous populace, aiding in their skill upgrade for better employability and taking steps to enhance their quality of life. Central to it was giving increasing responsibility to the locals (Kenyans). Elaborating on this, Titus Naikuni states that while there were twelve to fifteen expatriates in top positions when the soda ash plant was owned by ICI, there are only two Indians there at present.

Ratan speaks little about these initiatives, not giving the world at large much opportunity to know about them. This reticence has sometimes led to falsehoods being perpetuated about him; they were, however, short-lived.

A Fierce Nationalist

Ratan's sense of patriotism and nationalism were influenced by his early days in Tata House, which was situated opposite Azad Maidan in Bombay, a common venue for freedom fighters to gather to protest the colonial rule. Standing on the balcony, Ratan would witness the ill-treatment of Indian freedom fighters at the hands of the British. The British rule was 'oppressive', says Ratan.

He observed that the police was often ordered to lathi-charge Indian protesters. It made him very angry. He was all of six years old at the time. He recalls that he sometimes used to tiptoe outside to the motorcycles of the British police, furtively open the petrol tank lids and put sugar into them. That was his way of protesting. His fiercely nationalistic character follows